BREAKFAST BAKES · SWEET

Dense Apple Cider Donuts

Baked cake donuts flavored with reduced cider, dipped in spiced sugar.

MAKES **12 TO 14 DONUTS** · TOTAL **1 HR**
PAN **DONUT PAN** · OVEN **350F**

BEFORE YOU START

- Reduce the cider at least **30 minutes** ahead, or the night before, so it has time to cool.
- Egg and milk at room temperature.
- Preheat to **350F** and coat the donut pan with nonstick spray.
- Two donut pans let you bake everything at once; with one, bake in batches.

INGREDIENTS

Cider reduction

	1 1/2 cups	Apple cider 360 ml; fresh, not powdered mix

Dry bowl

250 g	2 cups	All-purpose flour spooned and leveled
	1 tsp	Baking soda
	3/4 tsp	Baking powder
	1 tsp	Ground cinnamon
	1 tsp	Apple pie spice
	1/4 tsp	Salt

Wet bowl

28 g	2 Tbsp	Unsalted butter melted
	1 large	Egg room temperature
100 g	1/2 cup	Brown sugar packed, light or dark
100 g	1/2 cup	Granulated sugar
	1/2 cup	Milk 120 ml, room temperature
	1 tsp	Pure vanilla extract

Topping

200 g	1 cup	Granulated sugar
	3/4 tsp	Ground cinnamon
	3/4 tsp	Apple pie spice
85 g	6 Tbsp	Unsalted butter melted

METHOD

Cider reduction

1. Simmer the cider in a small saucepan over low heat, stirring now and then. Start measuring at **10 minutes**, then every **3 to 5 minutes**. Leave any spices or solids that rise to the top; they go into the batter too.
   WAIT **ABOUT 20 MIN**
   ✓ *Down to 1/2 cup (120 ml), thick and concentrated*
2. Take off the heat and let it cool before it goes into the batter.
   WAIT **10 MIN OR MORE**

Batter

3. Whisk the flour, baking soda, baking powder, cinnamon, apple pie spice and salt in a large bowl.
4. In a second bowl, whisk the melted butter, egg, both sugars, milk and vanilla. Pour into the dry ingredients, add the cooled cider reduction, and whisk until smooth. The batter should be a little thick; that's what makes the crumb dense and cakey.
5. Scrape the batter into a large zip-top bag, snip off a corner, and pipe into the pan, filling each cavity about halfway.

Bake

6. Bake the donuts.
   WAIT **10 TO 11 MIN**
   ✓ *Edges and tops lightly browned; the top springs back when poked*
7. Cool in the pan, then turn out onto a wire rack. Re-grease the pan and bake the remaining batter.
   WAIT **2 MIN**

Coat

8. Stir the sugar, cinnamon and apple pie spice together in a medium bowl.
9. Once the donuts are cool enough to handle, dip both sides quickly in the melted butter, then coat generously in the spiced sugar. Don't let them soak: they drink butter fast, and if the bowl runs low, brush it on instead.

NOTES

Make ahead & storage

- Best the day they're made. Keeps covered at room temperature up to **2 days**, or in the fridge up to **5 days**.
- Freeze, coated or plain, up to **2 months**. Thaw overnight in the fridge and rewarm in the microwave.
- The cider reduction can be made the night before. The batter can't: the leaveners start working once wet meets dry, so bake soon after mixing.

Substitutions

- Apple pie spice: mix 4 parts cinnamon, 2 parts nutmeg and 1 part cardamom.
- Milk: the author usually uses buttermilk, but any dairy or nondairy milk works. 1/2 cup plain yogurt or sour cream gives a denser crumb.
- No donut pan: use a greased or lined 12-cup muffin pan, fill each cup 3/4 full, and bake at **350F** for **18 to 20 minutes**, until a toothpick comes out clean. Makes 10 to 12. With more cake and less coating per bite, they eat more like a muffin; the minis below come closest to a donut.
- Minis: grease a mini donut or mini muffin pan, fill 3/4 full, and bake at **350F** for **8 to 9 minutes**.

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APPLE · SPICED · FALL · FREEZER-FRIENDLY

Adapted from Sally's Baking Addiction, sallysbakingaddiction.com/baked-apple-cider-donuts. Method rewritten and condensed for personal kitchen use.